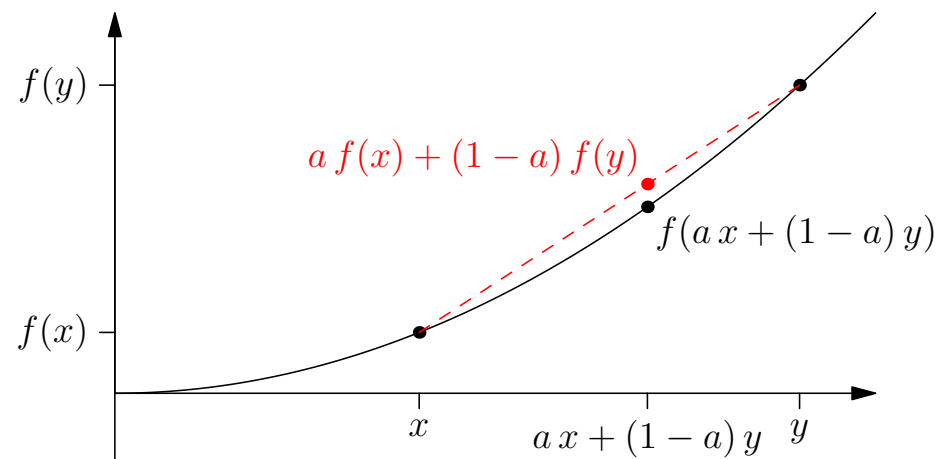


Mathematics of Machine Learning

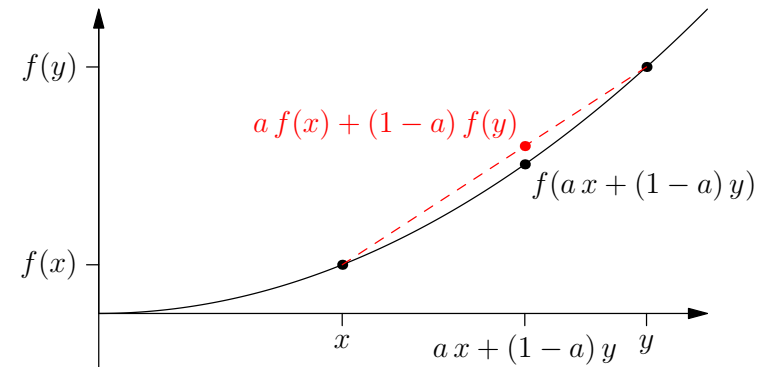
Convexity



Convex sets, convex functions, Jensen's inequality

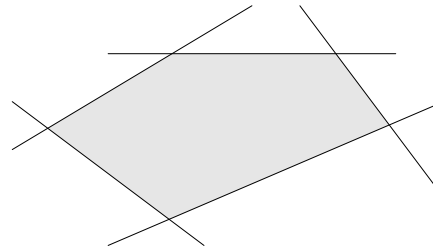
Outline

1. **Convex sets**
2. Convex functions
3. Jensen's inequality



Convex Regions

- Convex regions are familiar

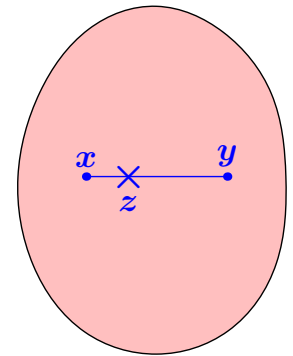


- For any two points x and y in a region $\mathcal{R}$ then for any $a \in [0,1]$ if

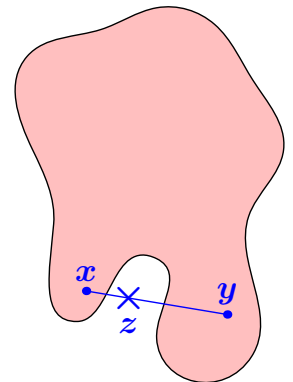
$$z = ax + (1 - a)y \in \mathcal{R}$$

- then $\mathcal{R}$ is a convex region

Convex region

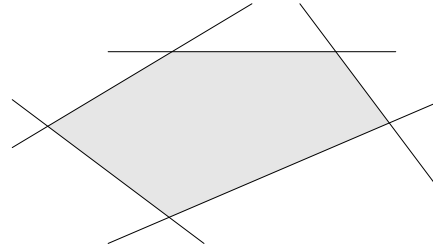


Non-convex region



Convex Regions

- Convex regions are familiar

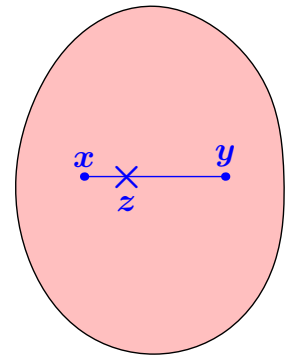


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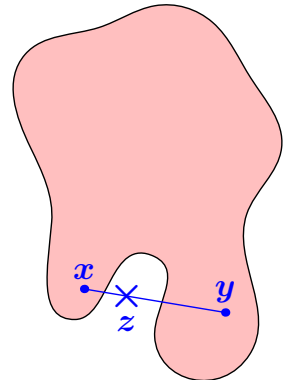
$$z = ax + (1 - a)y \in \mathcal{R}$$

- then $\mathcal{R}$ is a convex region

Convex region



Non-convex region



Convex Sets

- For any set, $\mathcal{S}$, where addition and scalar multiplication is defined (e.g. a vector space) then:

If for any two elements $\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \in \mathcal{S}$ and any $a \in [0, 1]$

$$\mathbf{z} = a\mathbf{x} + (1 - a)\mathbf{y} \in \mathcal{S}$$

then $\mathcal{S}$ is said to be a convex set

Positive Semi-Definite Matrices

- Recall that a matrix $\mathbf{M}$ is positive semi-definite if for any vector $\mathbf{v}$

$$\mathbf{v}^T \mathbf{M} \mathbf{v} \geq 0$$

- (We showed this also implies that all the eigenvalues are non-negative)
- We denote the fact that $\mathbf{M}$ is positive semi-definite by $\mathbf{M} \succeq 0$, and $\mathbf{M} \succ 0$ if it is positive definite
- The set of positive semi-definite (PSD) matrices (or kernels) form a convex set

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Proof

- Consider any two arbitrarily chosen PSD matrices $\mathbf{M}_1$ and $\mathbf{M}_2$ and any $a \in [0,1]$ then let

$$\mathbf{M}_3 = a\mathbf{M}_1 + (1 - a)\mathbf{M}_2$$

- Then for any vector $\mathbf{v}$

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{M}_3 \mathbf{v} &= \mathbf{v}^\top (a\mathbf{M}_1 + (1 - a)\mathbf{M}_2) \mathbf{v} \\ &= a\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{M}_1 \mathbf{v} + (1 - a)\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{M}_2 \mathbf{v} \\ &= am_1 + (1 - a)m_2\end{aligned}$$

where $m_1 = \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{M}_1 \mathbf{v}$ and $m_2 = \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{M}_2 \mathbf{v}$

- But $m_1, m_2 \geq 0$ since $\mathbf{M}_1, \mathbf{M}_2 \succeq 0$. Thus $am_1 + (1 - a)m_2 \geq 0$ and so $\mathbf{M}_3 \succeq 0$ $\square$

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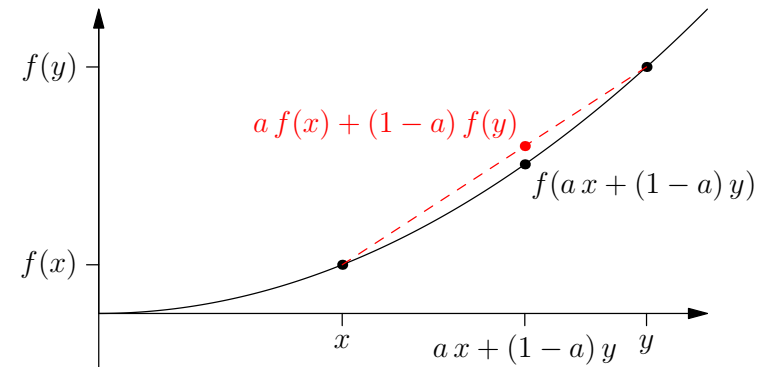
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Outline

1. Convex sets
2. **Convex functions**
3. Jensen's inequality



Convex Functions

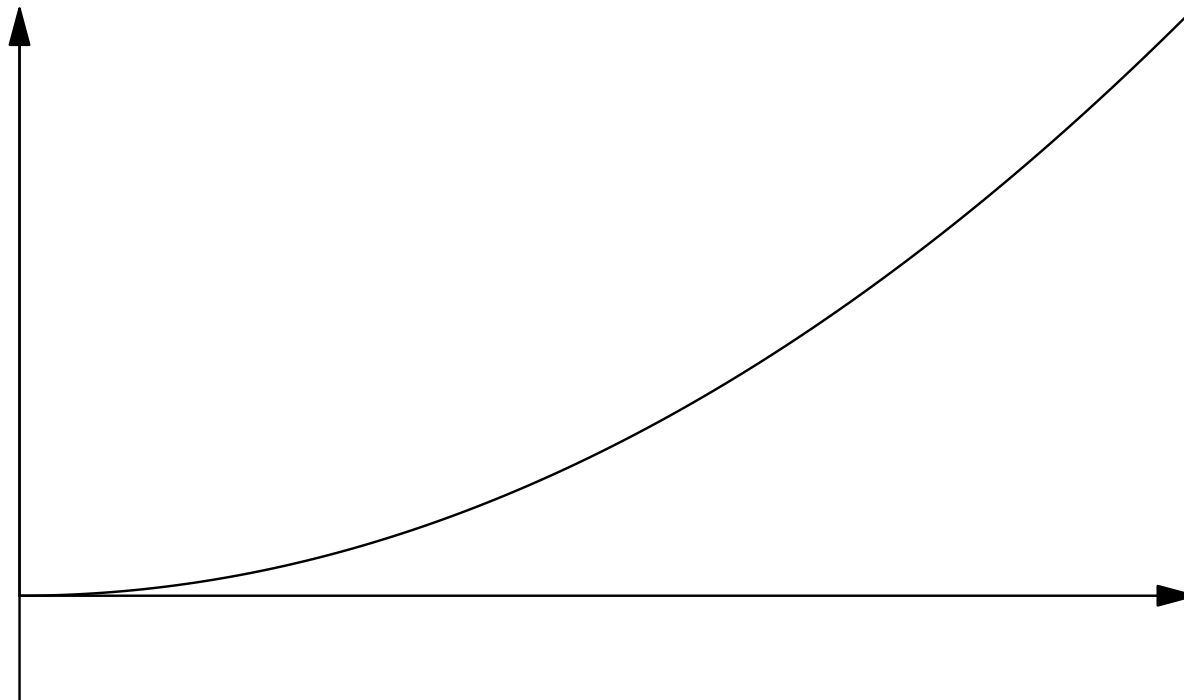
- Any function $f(x)$ is said to be a **convex function** if for any two points x and y and any $a \in [0,1]$

$$f(ax + (1 - a)y) \leq af(x) + (1 - a)f(y)$$

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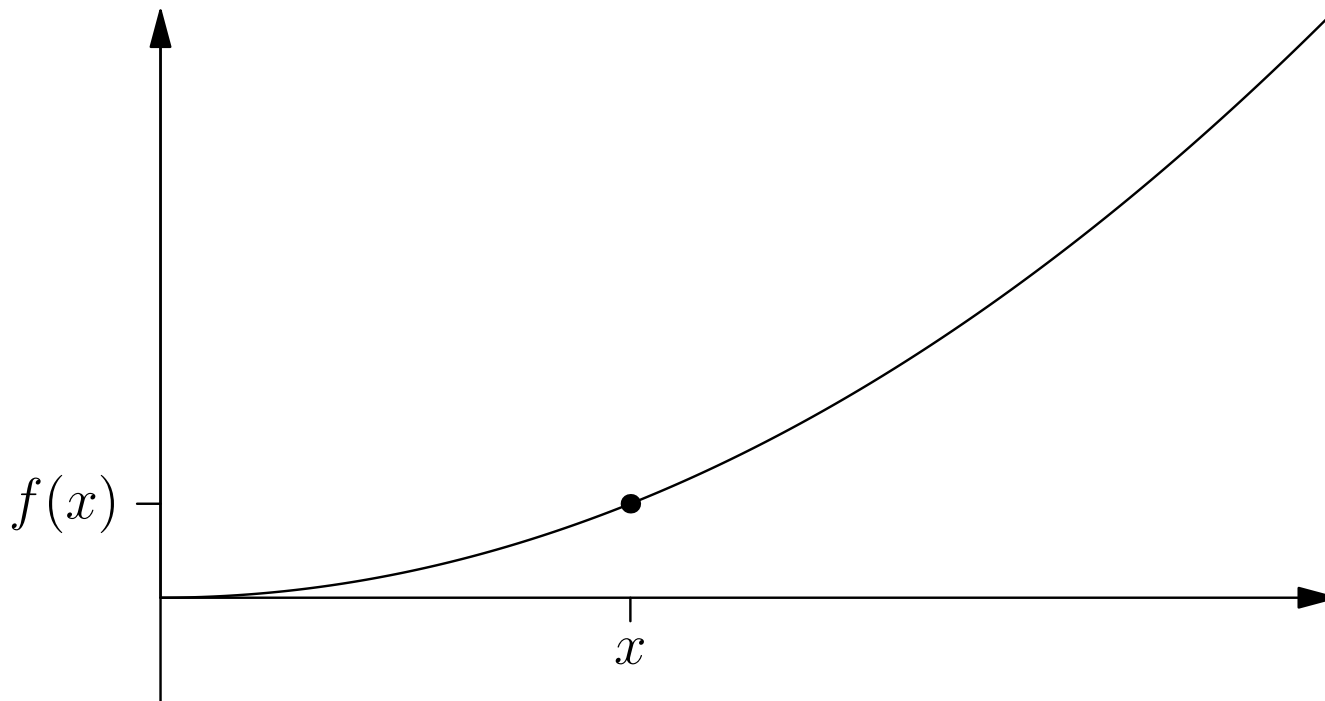
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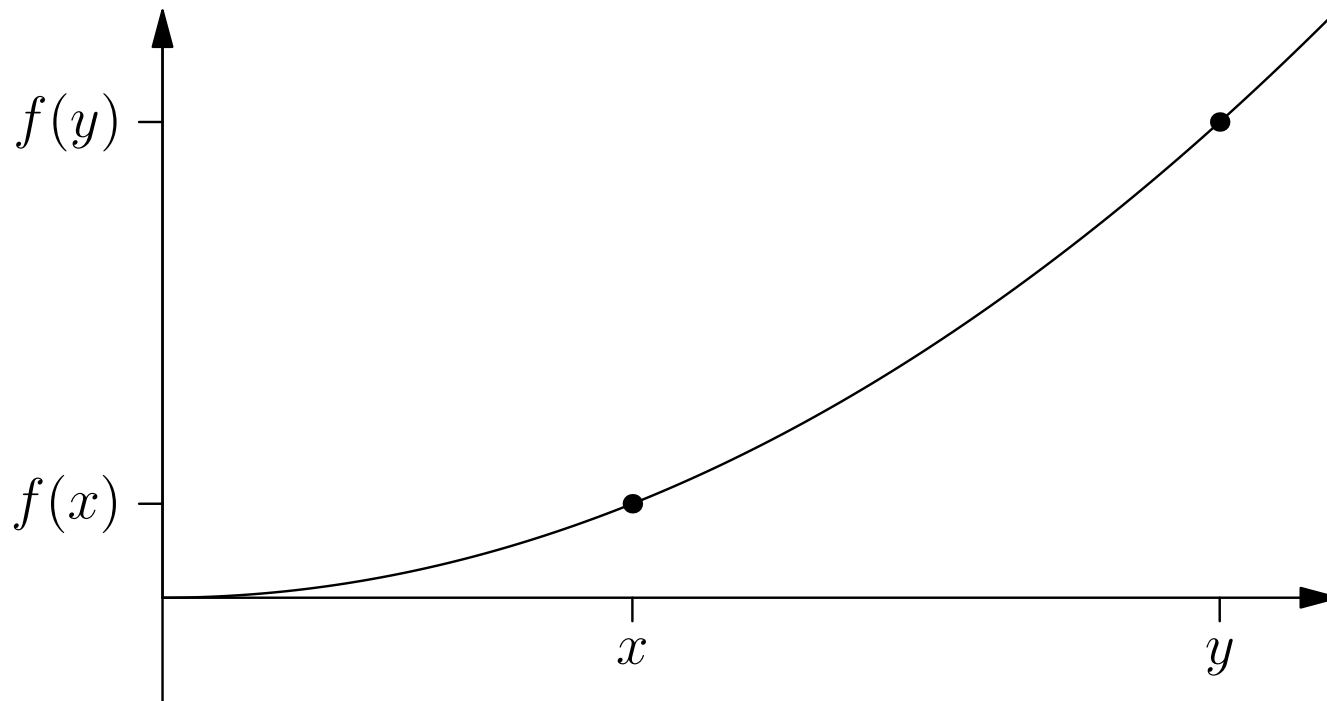
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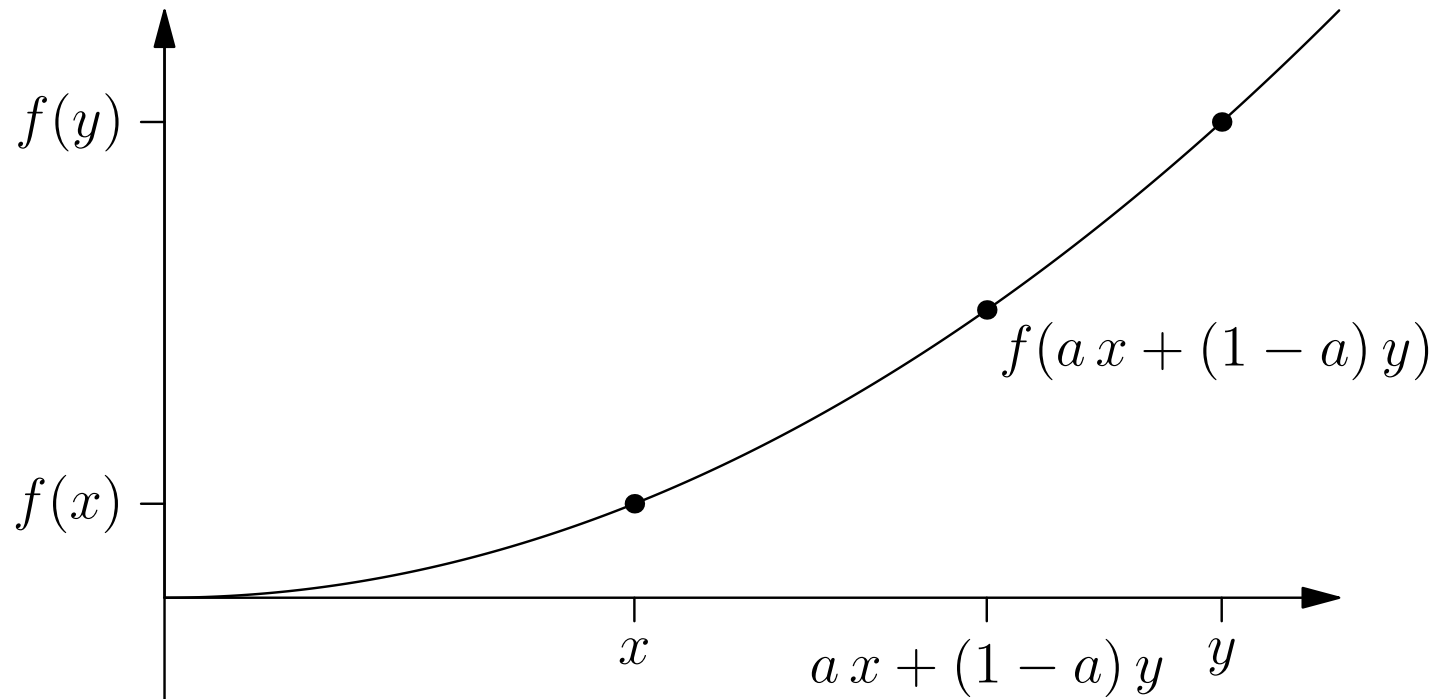
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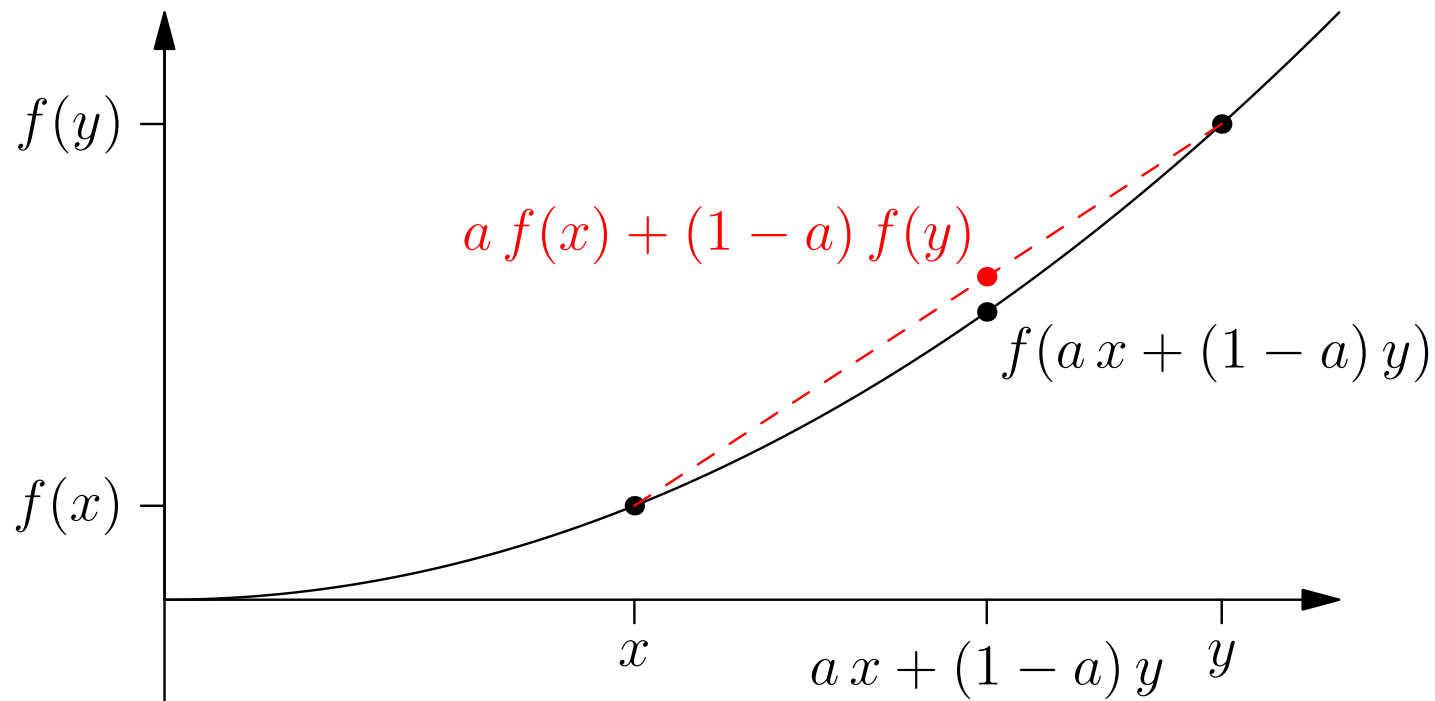
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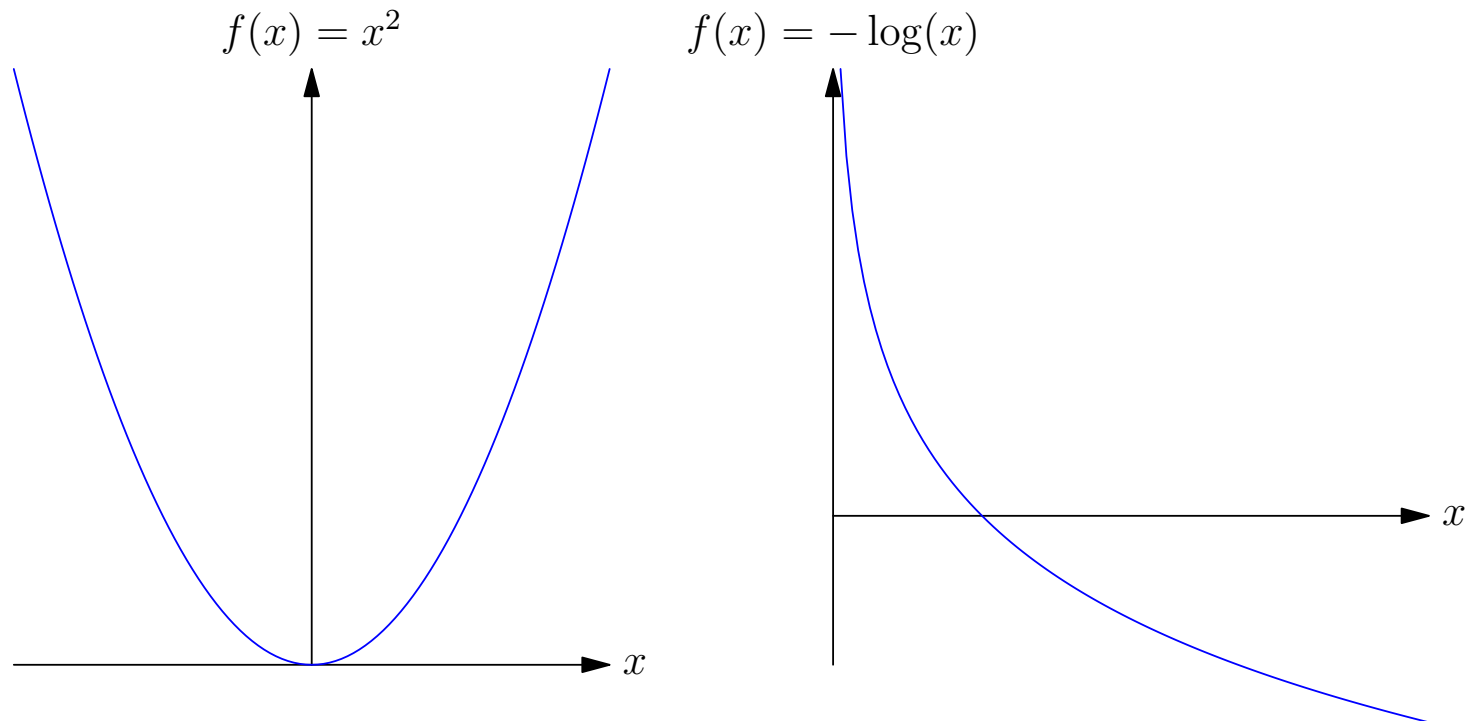
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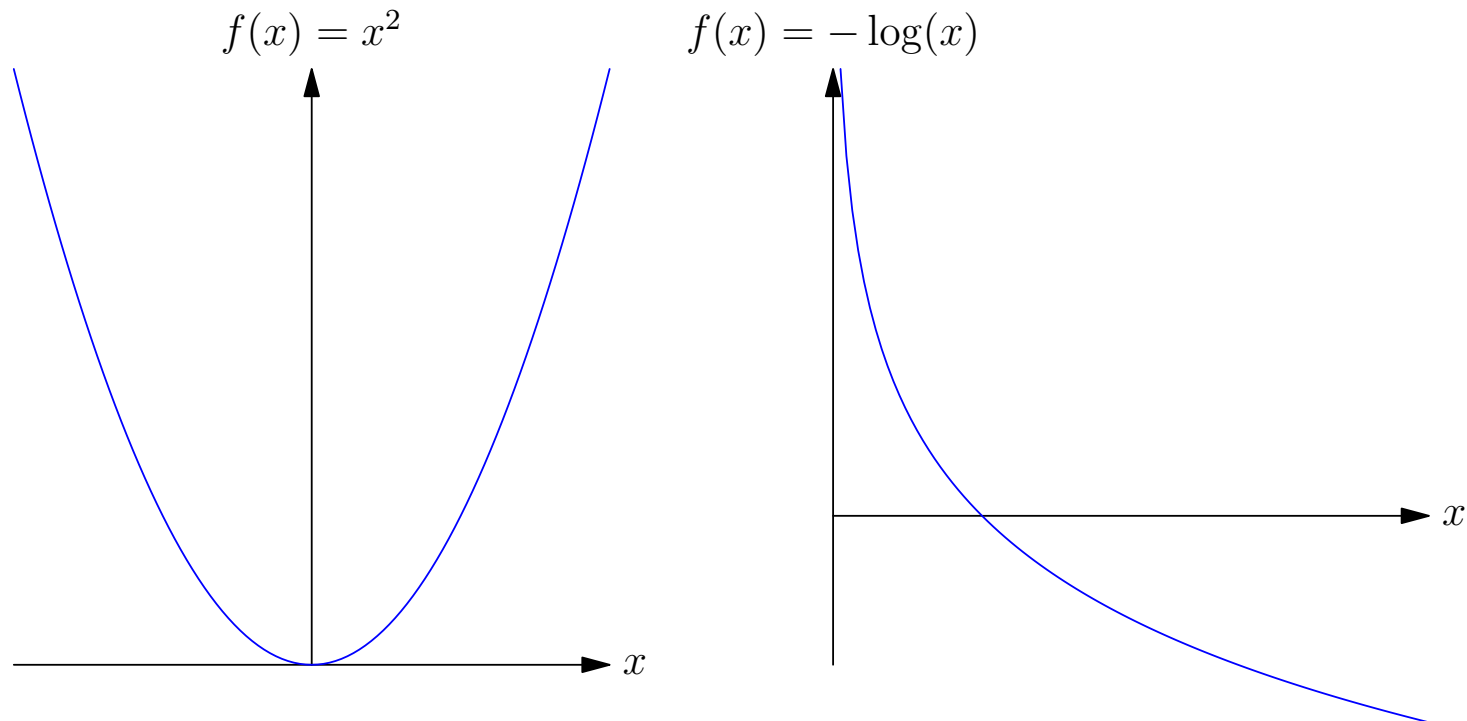
Epigraph

- The **epigraph** of a function is the area that lies above the function
- The epigraph of a convex function is a convex region



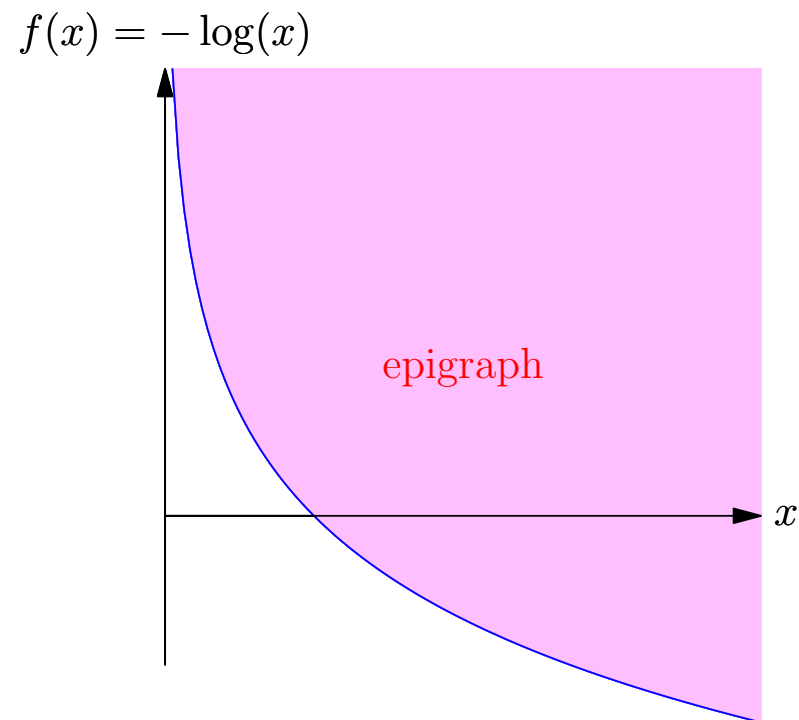
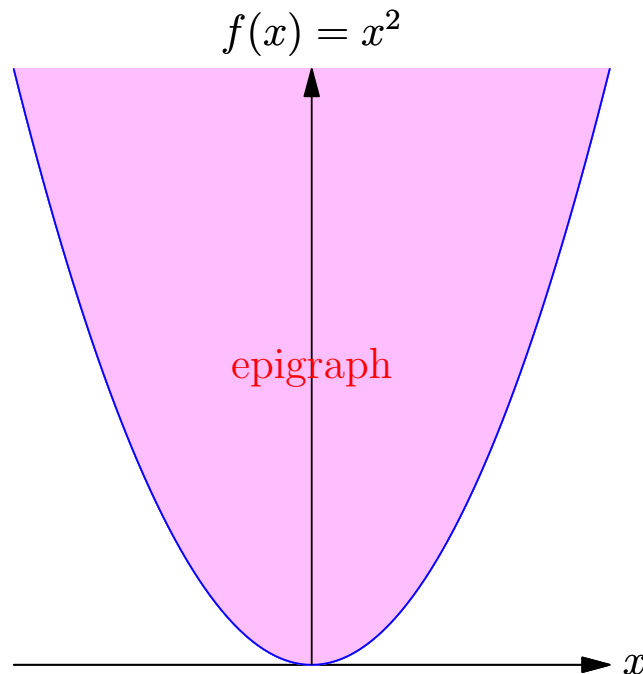
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Convex-Down or Concave Functions

- Any function, $f(x)$, that satisfies the inverse inequality

$$f(ax + (1 - a)y) \geq af(x) + (1 - a)f(y)$$

for any points x and y and any $a \in [0, 1]$ is said to be a **convex-down** or **concave** function

- Everything true for a convex(-up) function carries over to a convex-down function with a small modification
- If $f(x)$ is a convex-up function then $g(x) = -f(x)$ is a convex-down function
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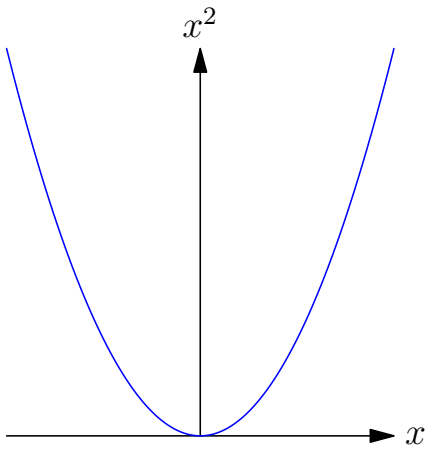
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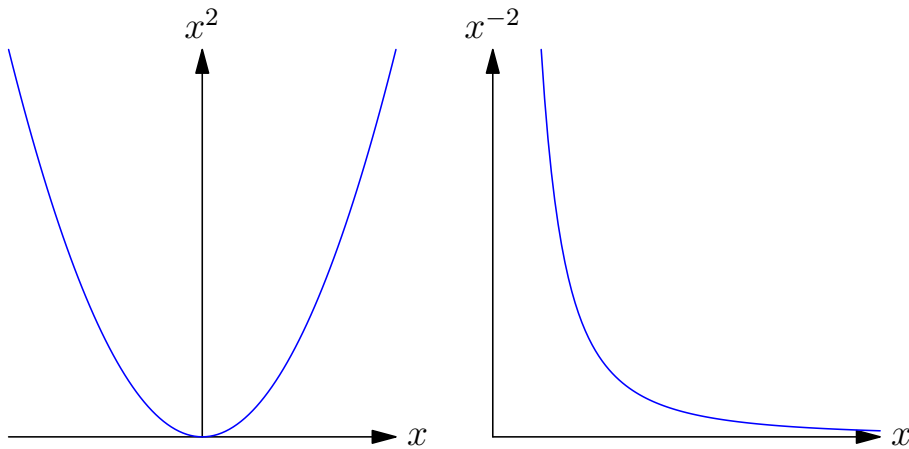
Examples

Convex-Up Functions



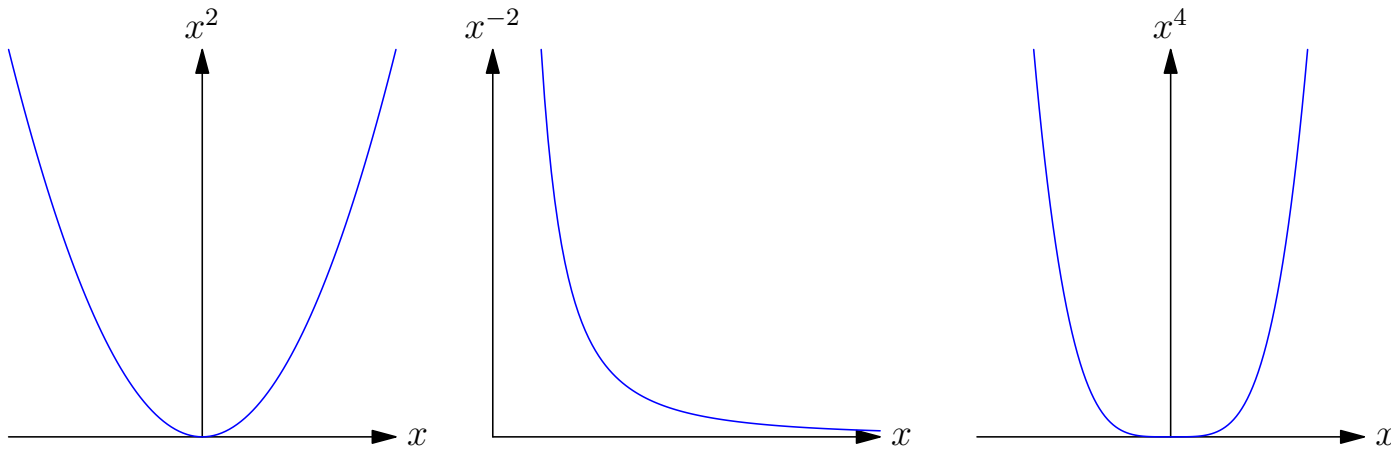
Examples

Convex-Up Functions



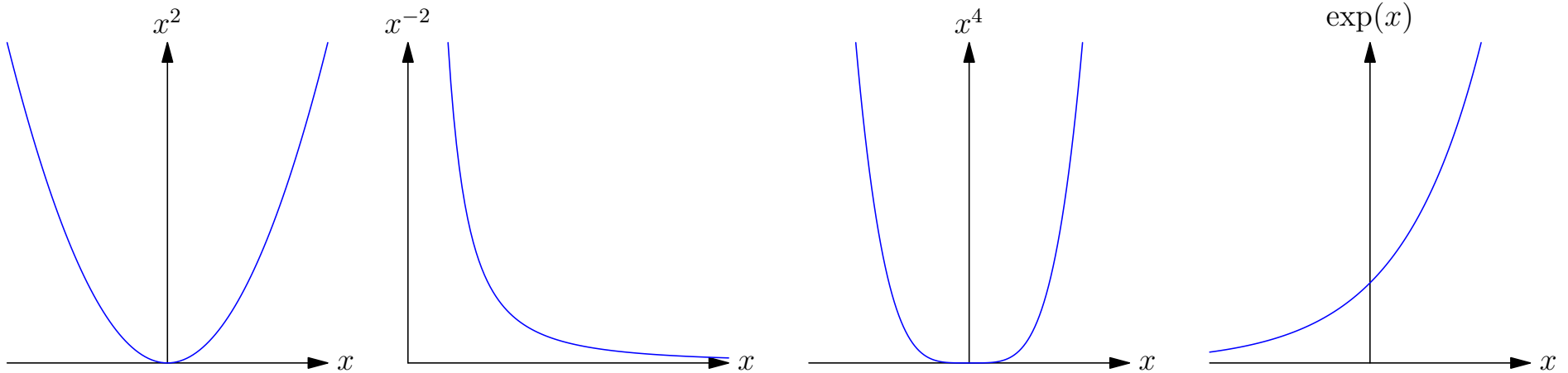
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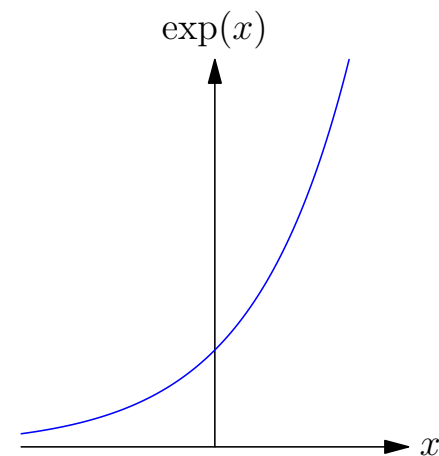
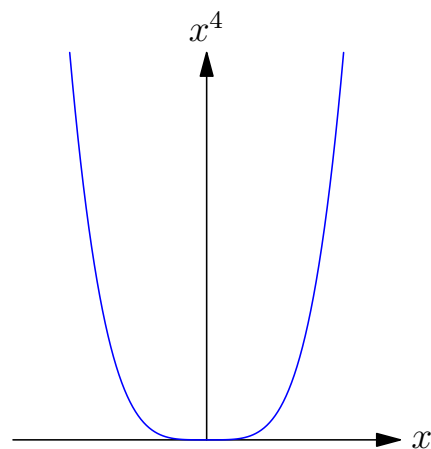
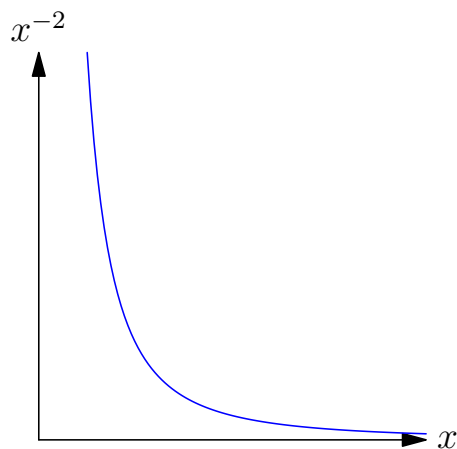
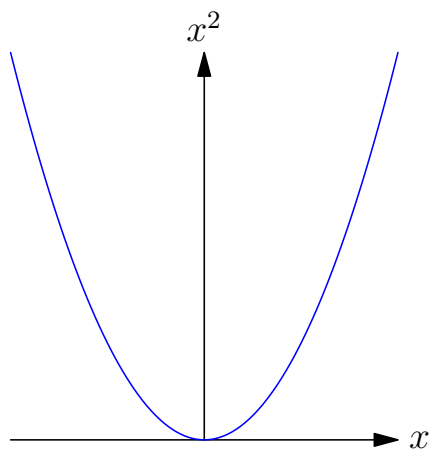
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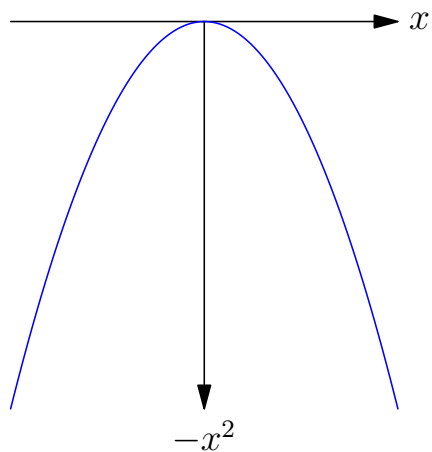


Examples

Convex-Up Functions

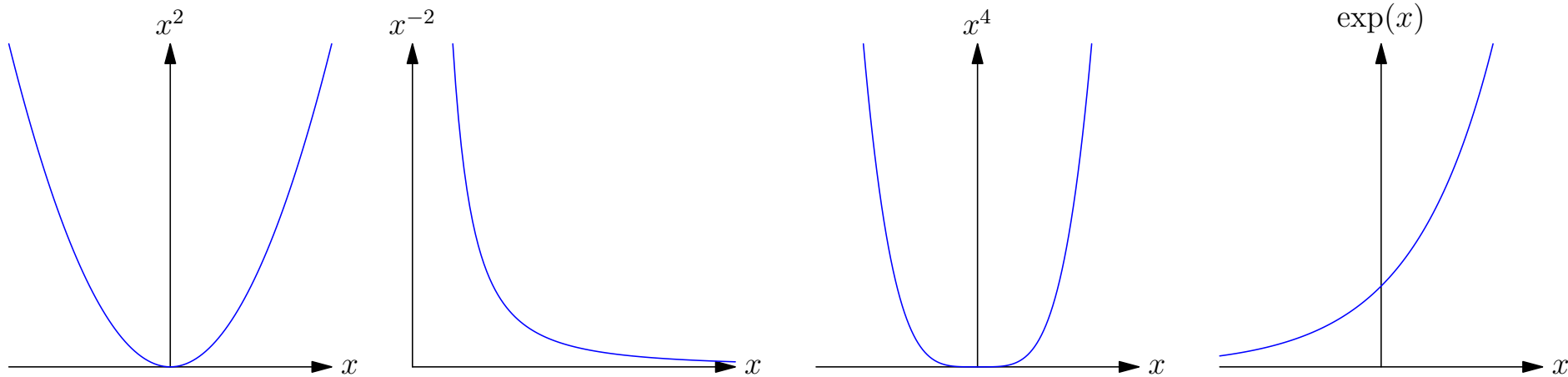


Convex-Down Functions

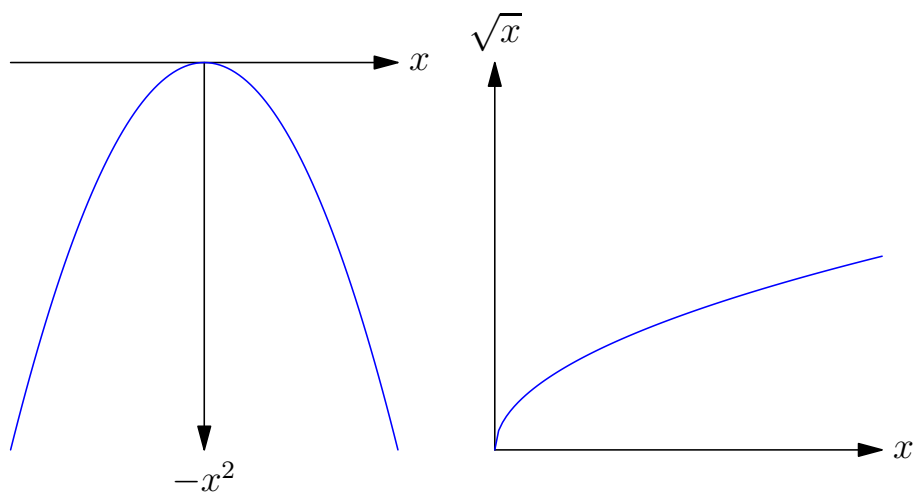


Examples

Convex-Up Functions

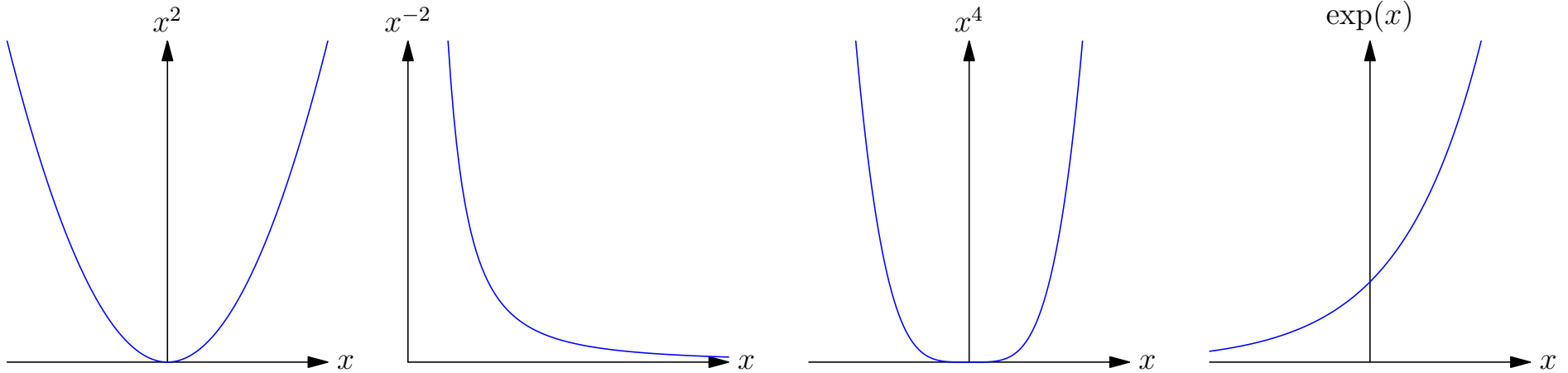


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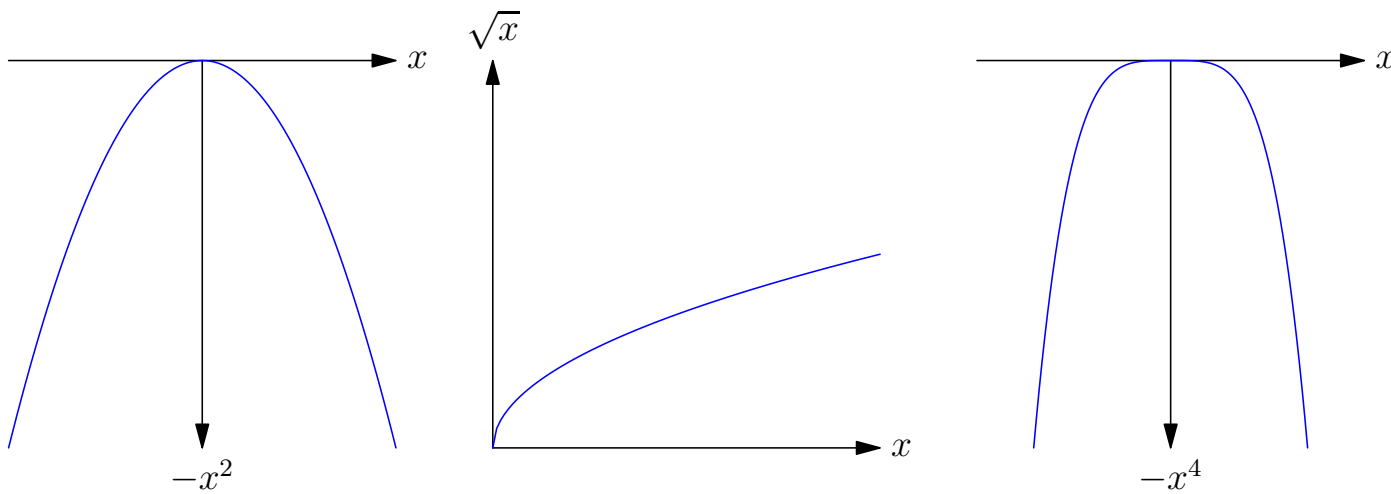


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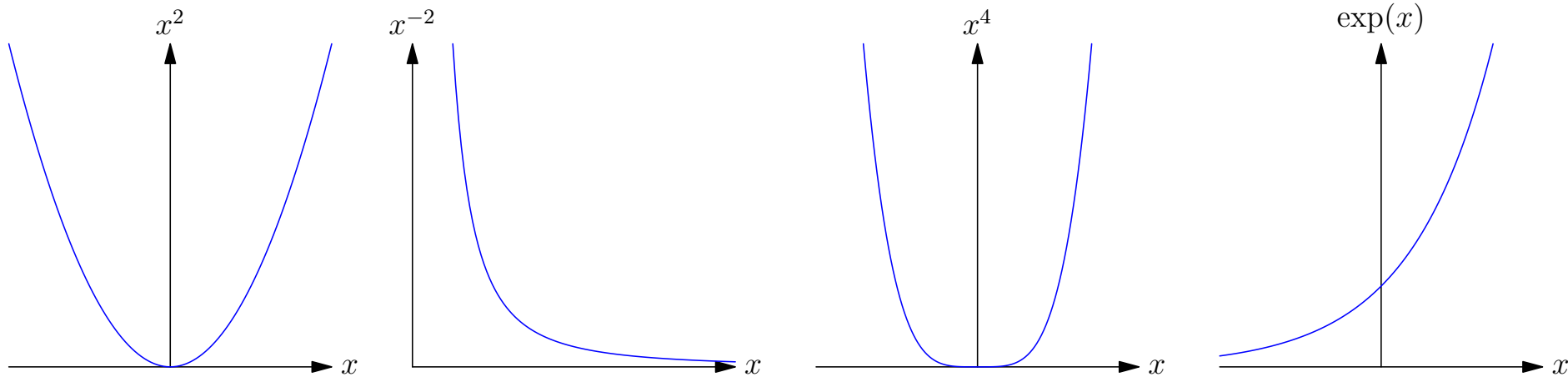


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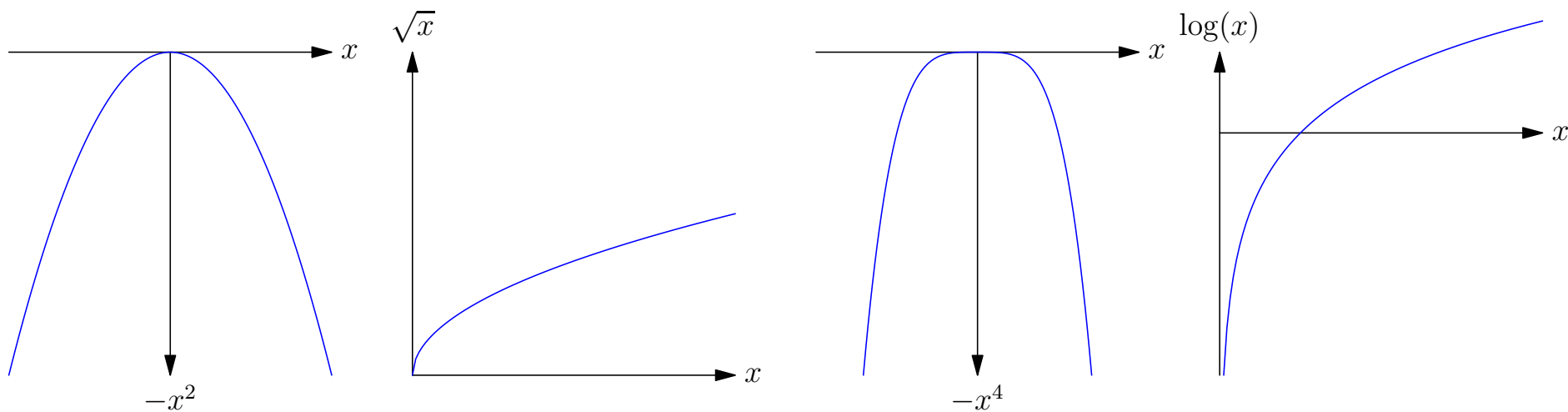


Examples

Convex-Up Functions



Convex-Down Functions



Linear Functions

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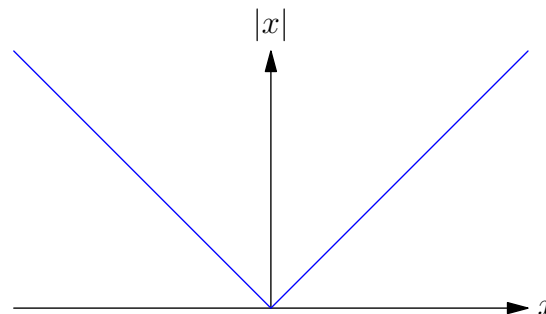
$$f(x) = mx + c$$

- They satisfy the **equality**

$$f(ax + (1 - a)y) = af(x) + (1 - a)f(y)$$

- As such they are both convex(-up) and convex-down function

- $|x|$ is a convex-up function



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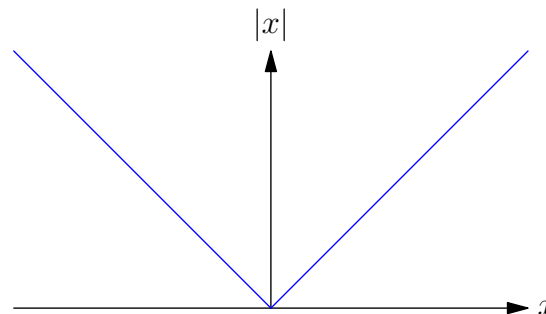
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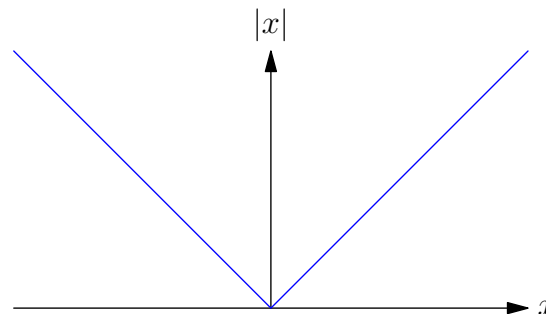
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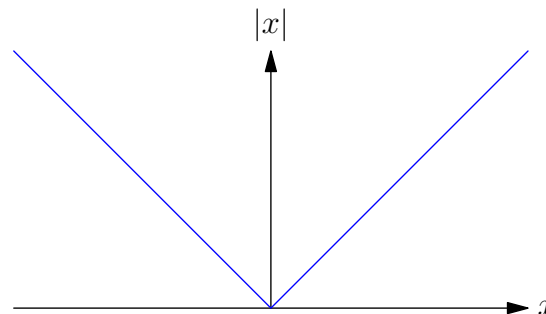
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Strictly Convex Function

- Functions that satisfy the strict inequality (for $0 < a < 1$ and $x \neq y$)

$$f(ax + (1 - a)y) < af(x) + (1 - a)f(y)$$

are said to be **strictly convex functions**

- A strictly convex-down function satisfies the reverse strict inequality
- Strictly convex-(up or down) functions don't contain any linear regions

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- Functions that satisfy the strict inequality (for $0 < a < 1$ and $x \neq y$)

$$f(ax + (1 - a)y) < af(x) + (1 - a)f(y)$$

are said to be **strictly convex functions**

- A strictly convex-down function satisfies the reverse strict inequality
- Strictly convex-(up or down) functions don't contain any linear regions

Convexity in High Dimensions

- If $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ (i.e. $f(\mathbf{x})$ maps high dimensional point $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ to a real value) satisfies

$$f(a\mathbf{x} + (1 - a)\mathbf{y}) \leq af(\mathbf{x}) + (1 - a)f(\mathbf{y})$$

for any $\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and any $a \in [0, 1]$ then $f(\mathbf{x})$ is a convex function

- $\|\mathbf{x}\|_2^2 = \sum_i x_i^2$ is a (strictly) convex function
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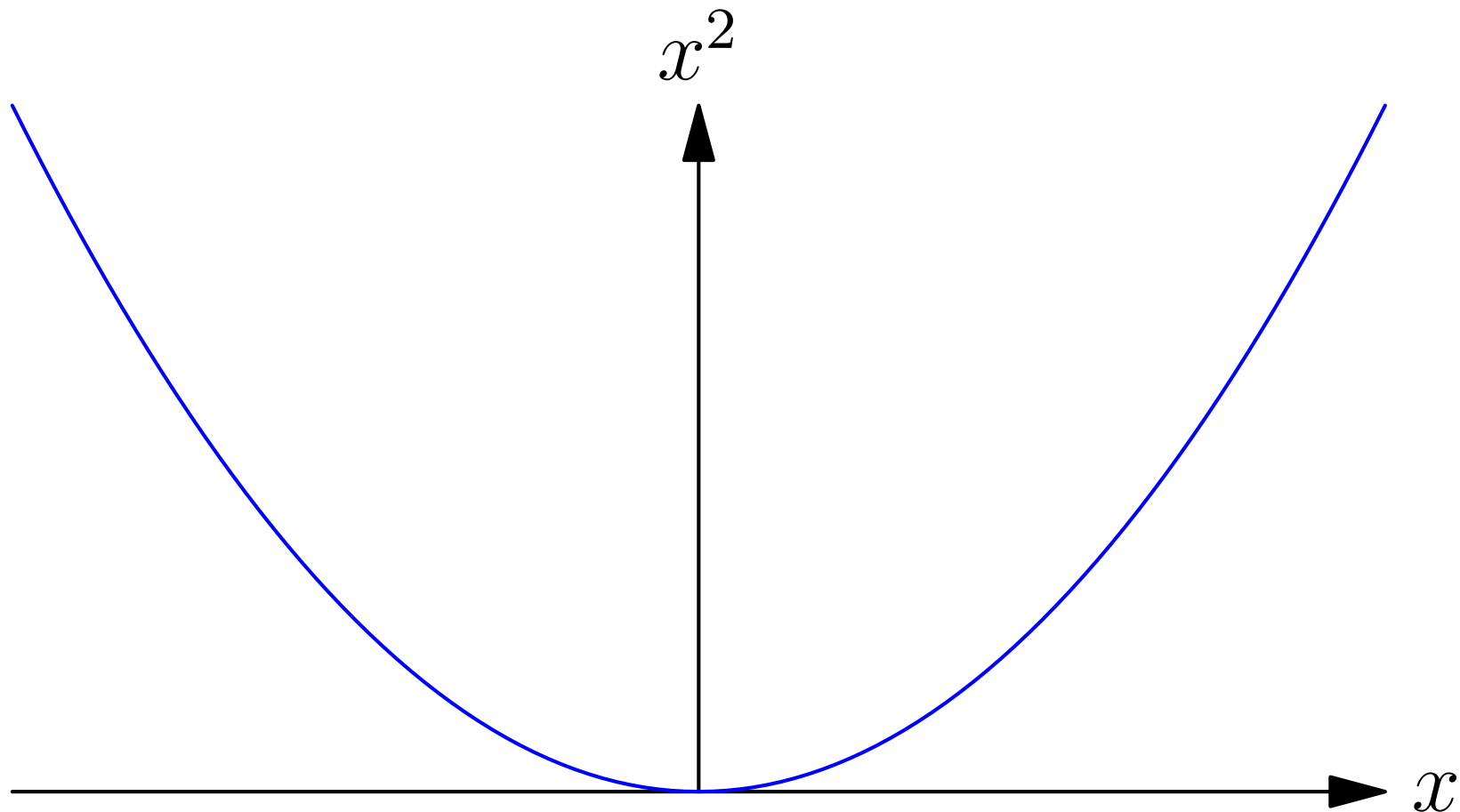
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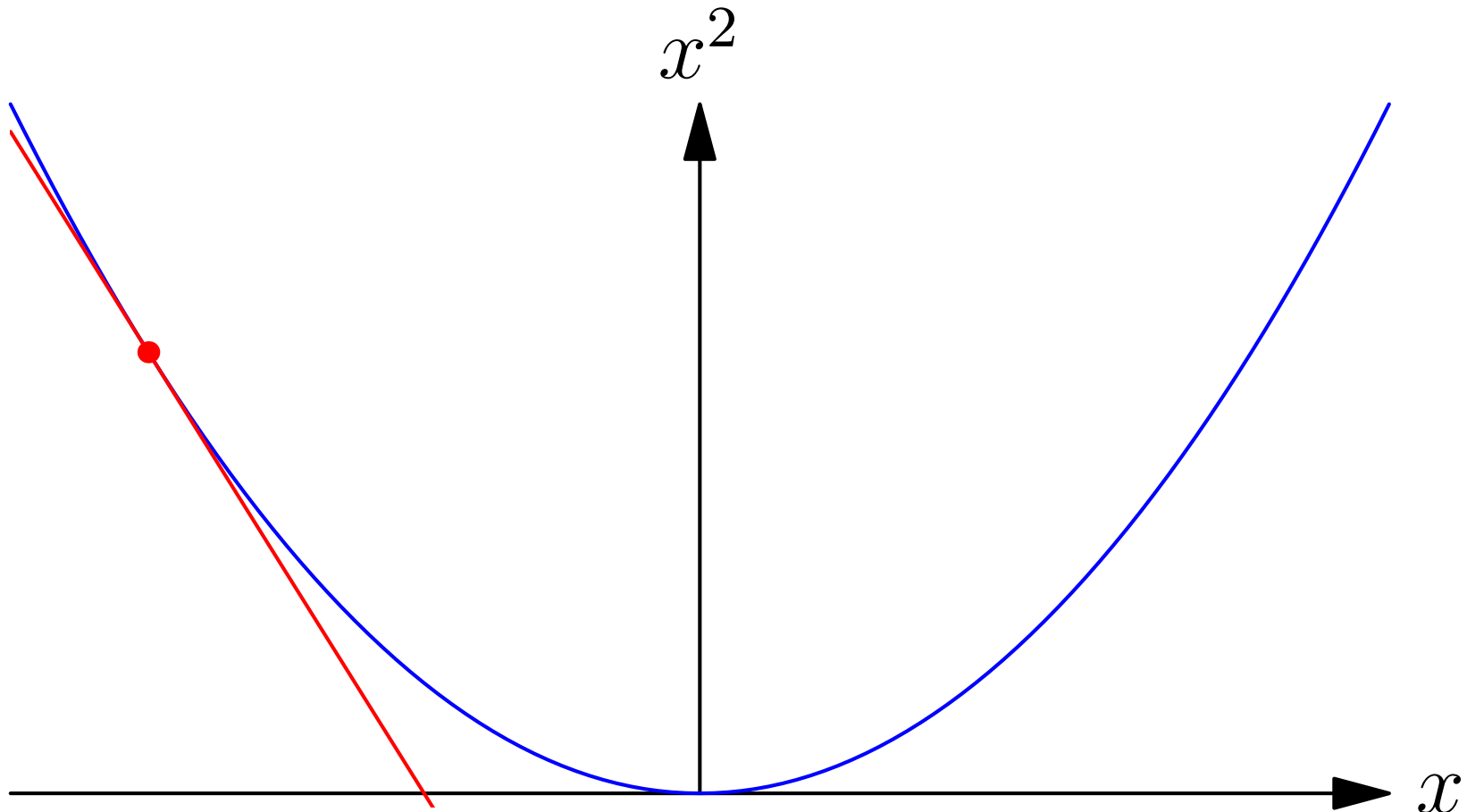
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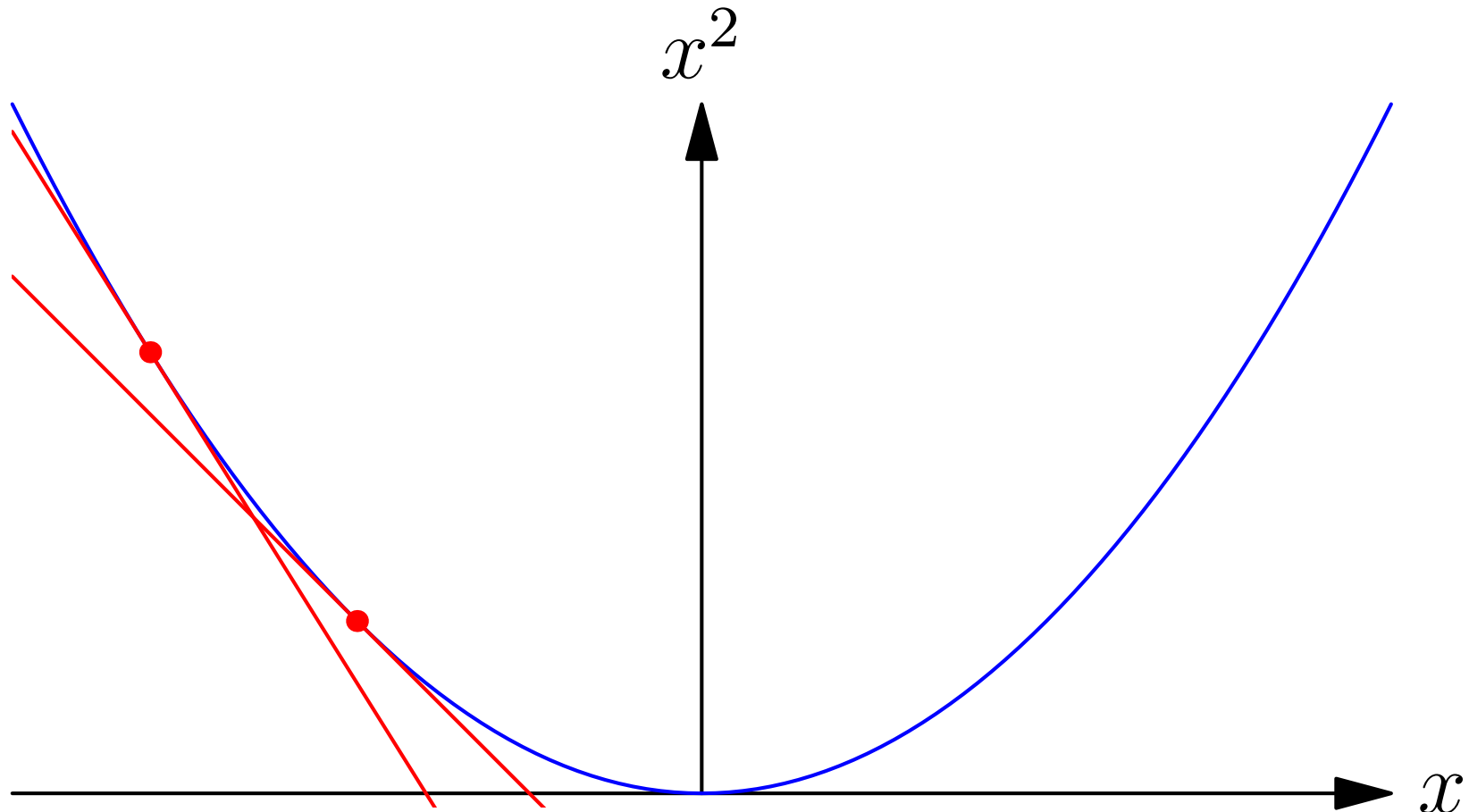
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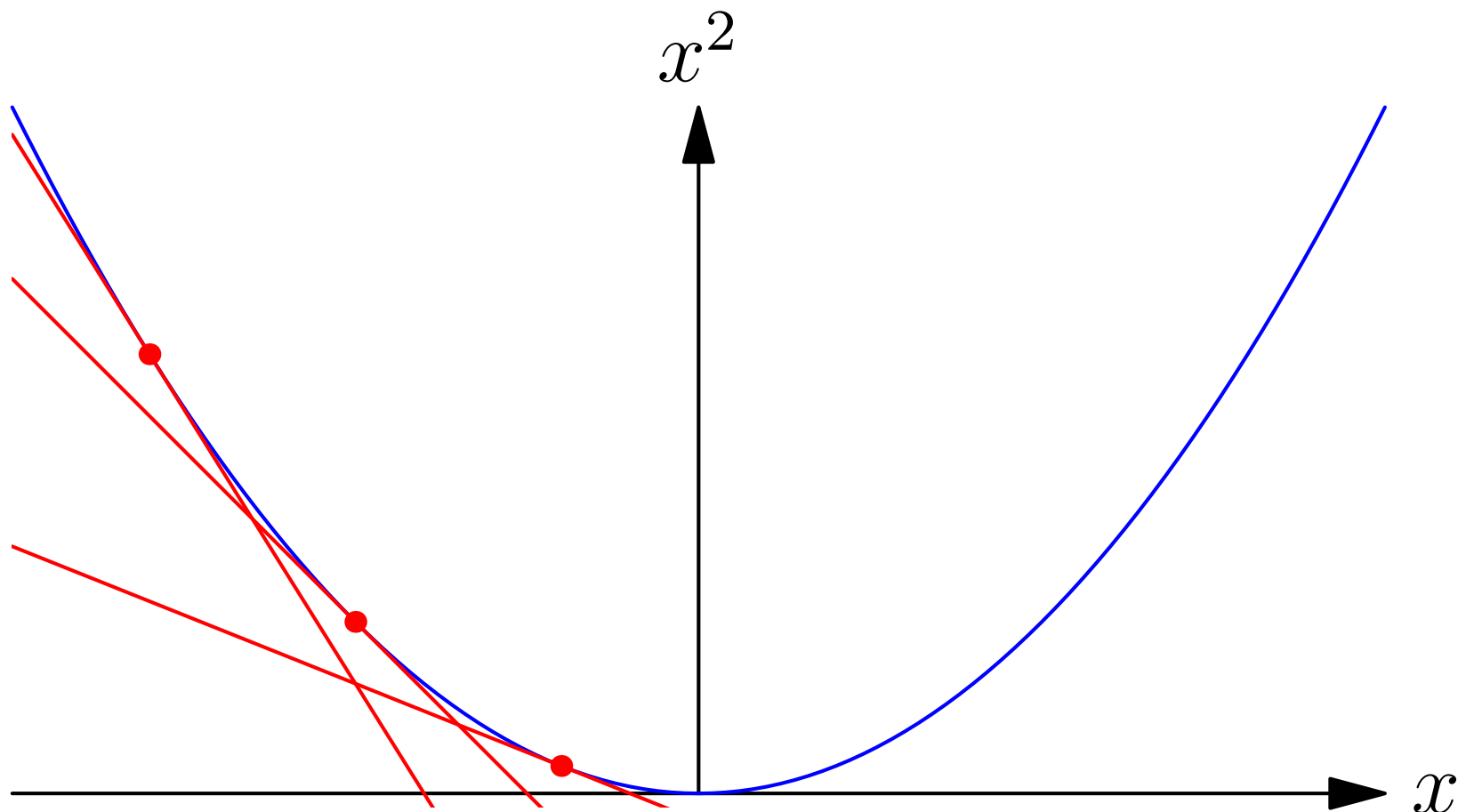
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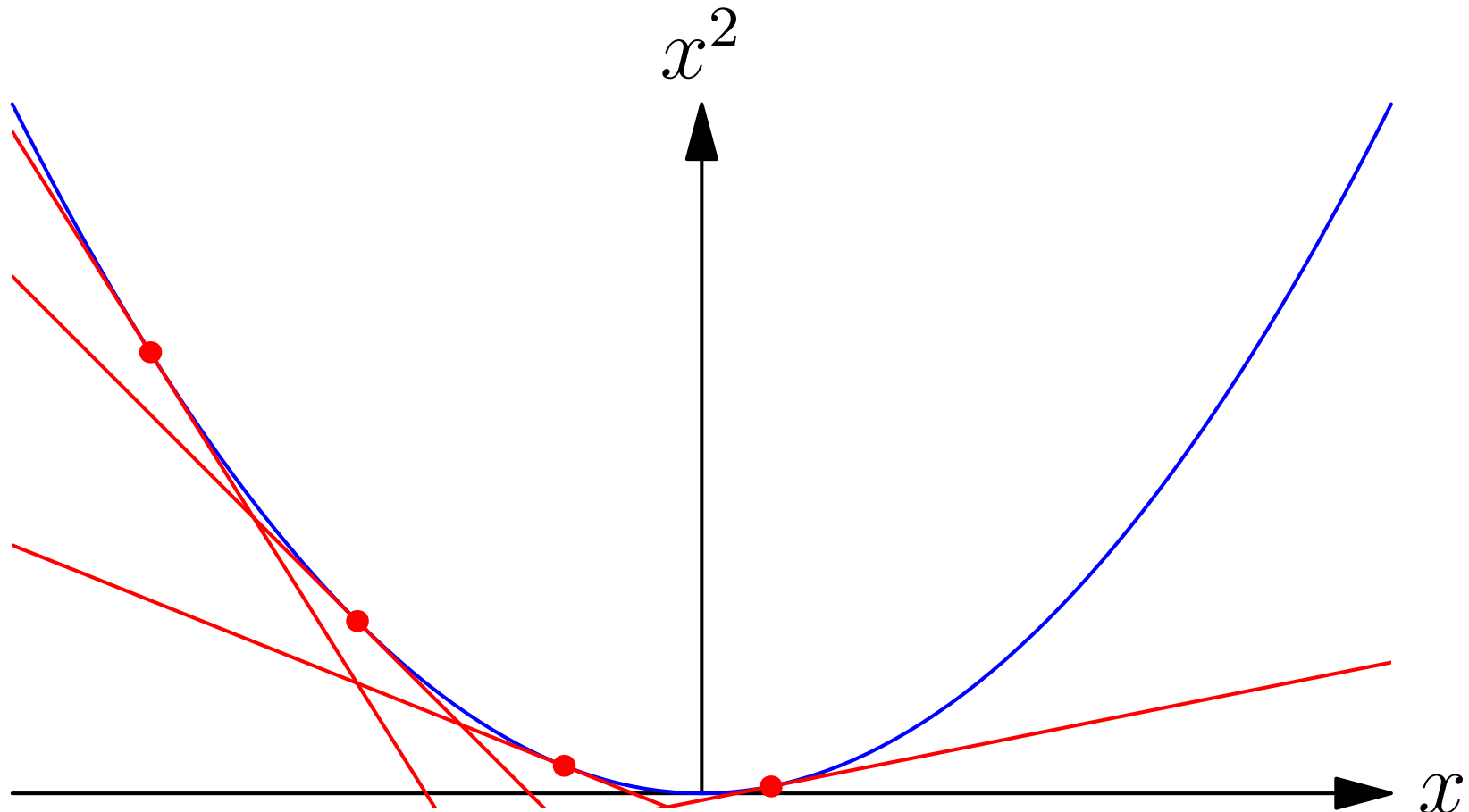
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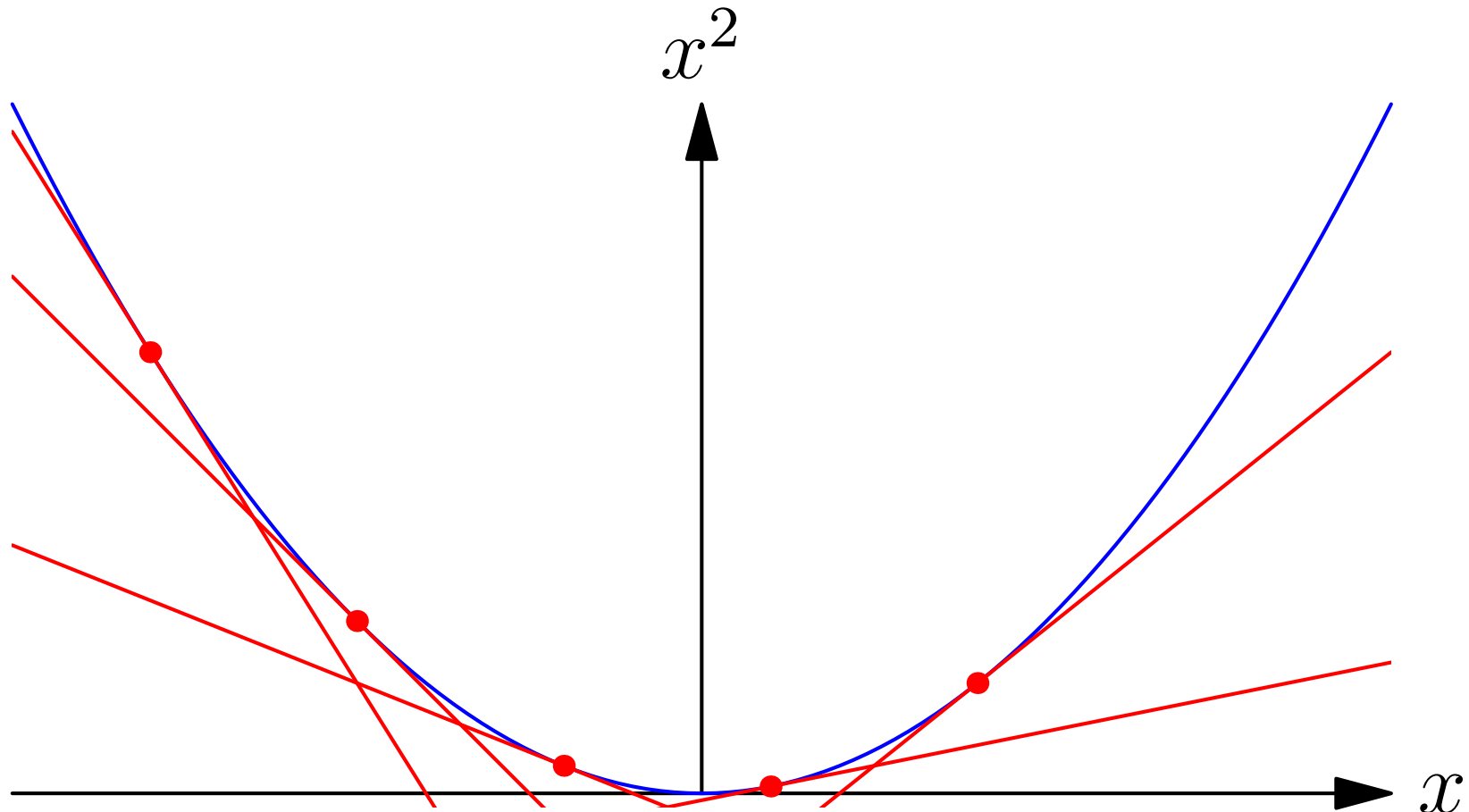
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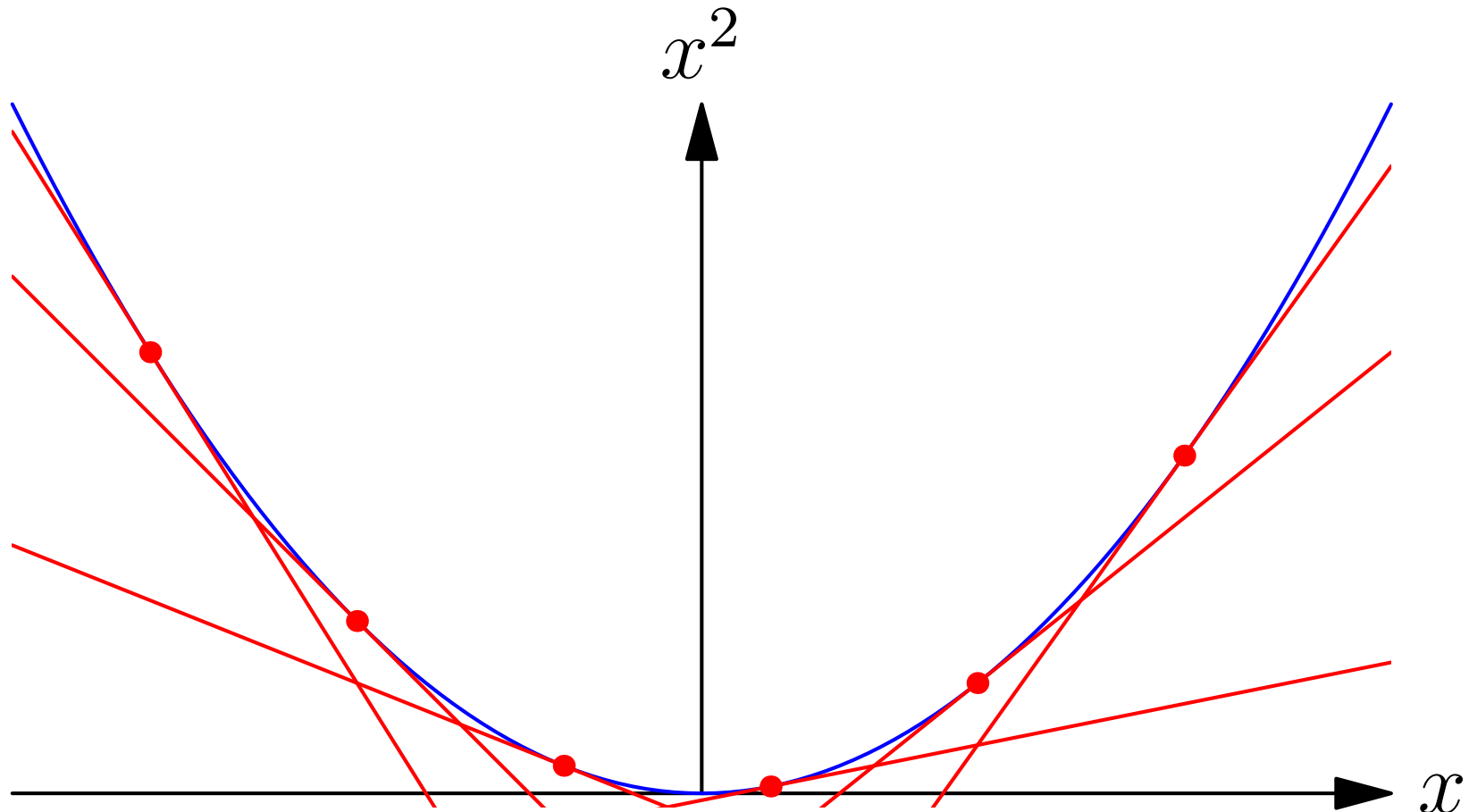
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Second Derivatives

- As $f(x)$ lies on or above its tangent line then for any $\epsilon > 0$

$$f'(x + \epsilon) \geq f'(x)$$

therefore $f''(x) = \lim_{\epsilon \rightarrow 0} (f'(x + \epsilon) - f'(x))/\epsilon \geq 0$ at all points x

- In high dimensions a convex function lies above its tangent plane

$$f(\mathbf{x}) \geq f(\mathbf{x}^*) + (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}^*)^\top \nabla f(\mathbf{x}^*)$$

- The matrix of second derivatives (the Hessian) must be positive semi-definite at all points $\mathbf{x}$

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- $f(x) = x^2$ is strictly convex as $f''(x) = 2 > 0$
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- For any set of convex functions $f_1(x), f_2(x), \dots$ and any set of non-negative scalars $a_1, a_2, \dots$ then

$$g(x) = \sum_i a_i f_i(x)$$

is convex

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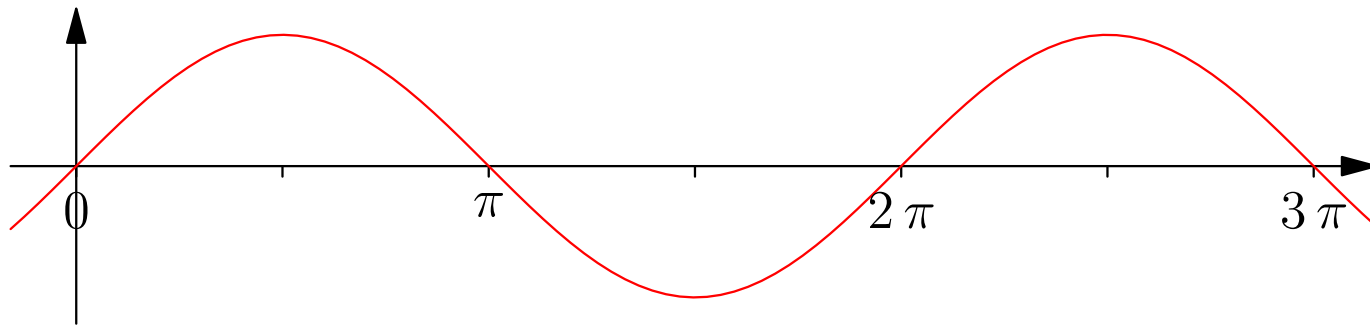
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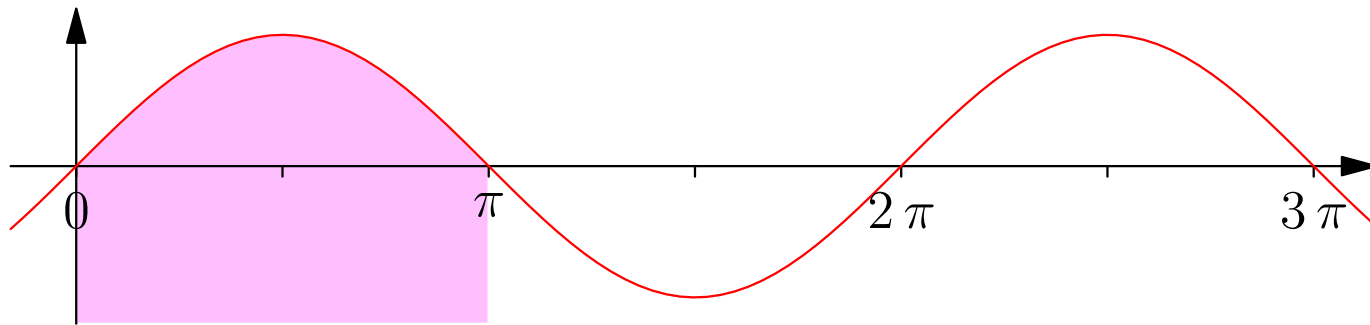
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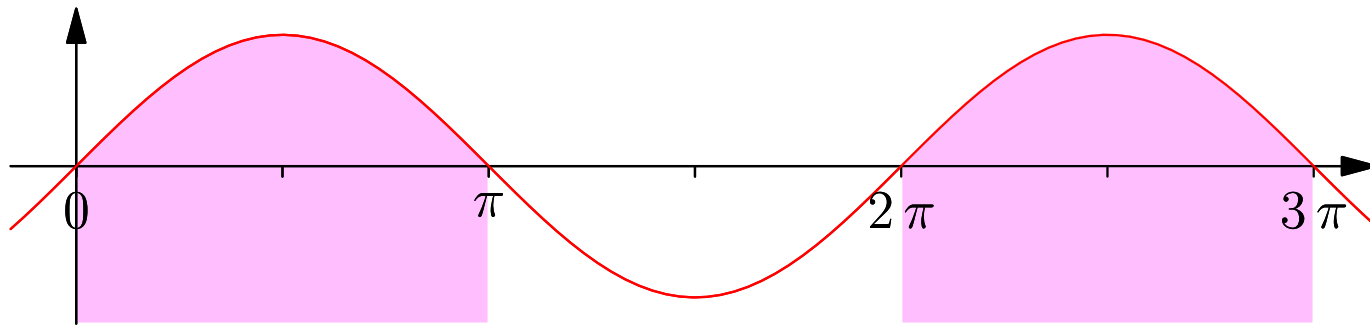
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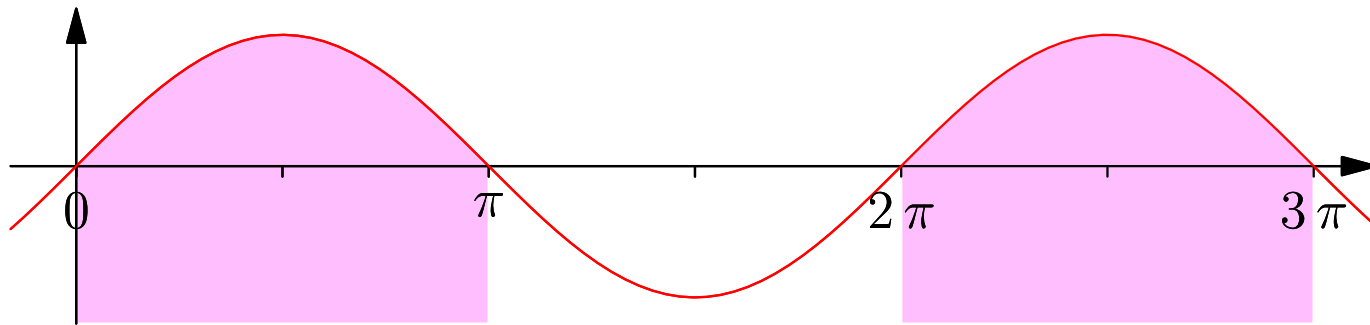
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$$x_i > 0 \qquad \mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{x} = b \qquad \mathbf{x}^\top \mathbf{M} \mathbf{x} \leq 1$$

- Linear constraints (e.g. $x_i > 0$ or $\mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{x} = b$ or $\mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{x} \leq b$) always define a convex region
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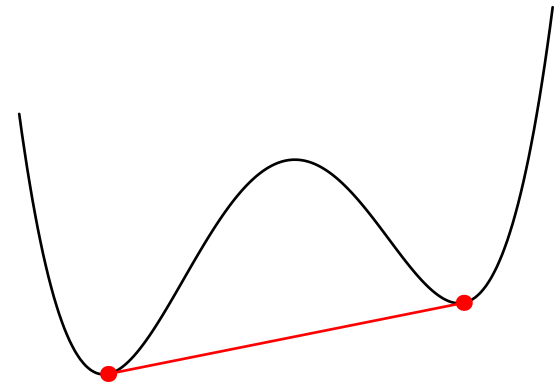
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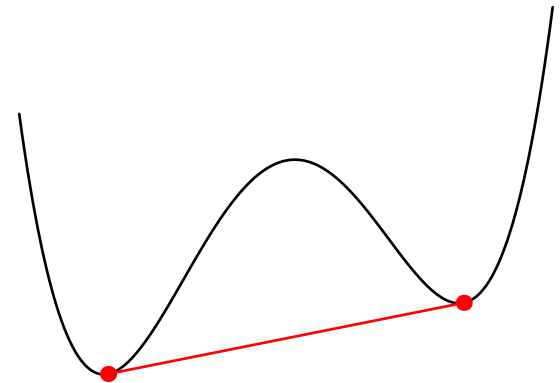
Unique Minimum

- Strictly convex function have a unique minimum
- The existence of a local minimum would break convexity
 - ★ The line connecting a local minimum to a global minimum would be strictly decreasing
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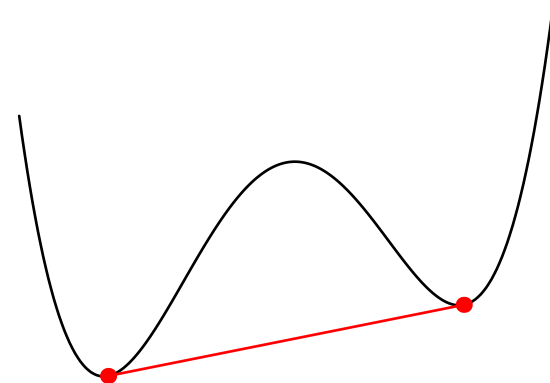
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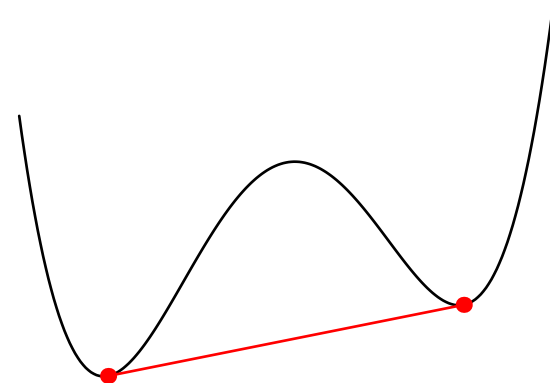
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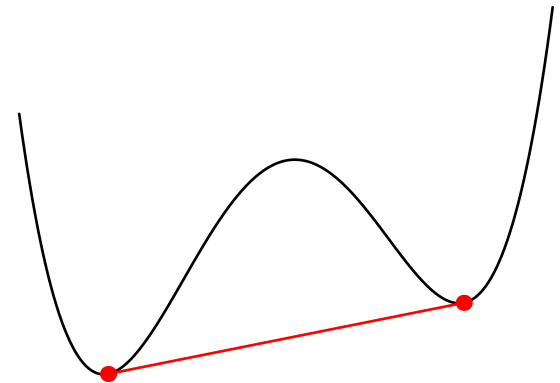
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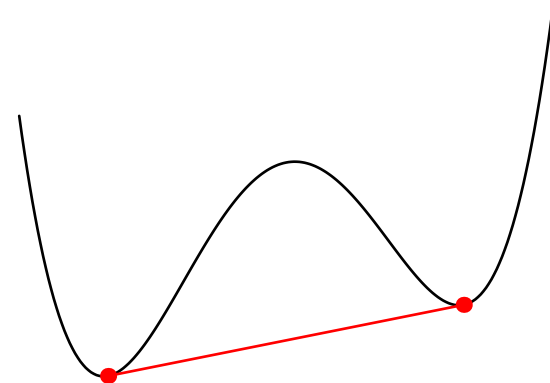
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Convex Set of Minima

- If $f(x)$ is **convex** but not **strictly convex** then there might exist a convex set $\mathcal{M} \subset \mathcal{X}$ of minima such that for all $x, y \in \mathcal{M}$ and any $z \in \mathcal{X}$ we have $f(x) = f(y) \leq f(z)$
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- The sum of a convex function, $f(x)$, and a strictly convex function $g(x)$ will always be strictly convex since

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- For linear regression the loss function

$$L(\mathbf{w}) = \|\mathbf{X}\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{y}\|^2 = \mathbf{w}^\top \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} \mathbf{w} - 2\mathbf{w}^\top \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{y} + \mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{y}$$

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- If $\mathbf{H} \succ 0$ there will be a unique minima, while if $\mathbf{H}$ has some zero eigenvalues there will be a family of solutions

Regularised Linear Regression

- In ridge regression we minimise a loss

$$L(\mathbf{w}) = \|\mathbf{X}\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{y}\|^2 + \eta\|\mathbf{w}\|^2 = \mathbf{w}^\top (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} + \eta \mathbf{I}) \mathbf{w} - 2\mathbf{w}^\top \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{y} + \mathbf{y}^\top \mathbf{y}$$

- Because $\|\mathbf{w}\|^2$ is strictly convex the loss function is strictly convex and so will have a unique solution
- Using an L_1 regulariser (Lasso)

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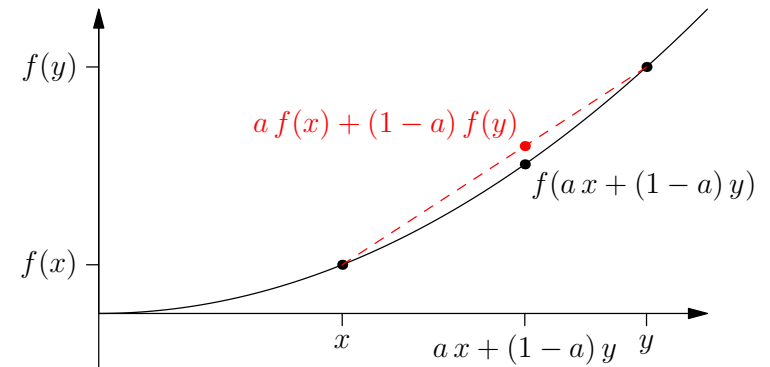
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Outline

1. Convex sets
2. Convex functions
3. **Jensen's inequality**



Jensen's Inequality

- In proving many properties of learning machines inequalities are really useful
- One of the most useful inequalities involve expectations of convex functions, this is known as **Jensen's Inequality**
- If $f(\mathbf{x})$ is a convex(-up) function then

$$\mathbb{E}[f(\mathbf{X})] \geq f(\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{X}])$$

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- If $f(x)$ is a convex(-up) function then

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- If $f(x)$ is a convex(-down) function then

$$\mathbb{E}[f(\mathbf{X})] \leq f(\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{X}])$$

Proof

- We said before that a convex function must lie on or above its tangent plane at any point $\mathbf{x}^*$

$$f(\mathbf{x}) \geq f(\mathbf{x}^*) + (\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}^*)^\top \nabla f(\mathbf{x}^*)$$

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Simple Proofs with Jensen's Inequality

- Since $f(x) = x^2$ is convex by Jensen's inequality

$$\mathbb{E}[X^2] \geq (\mathbb{E}[X])^2 \quad \text{or} \quad \mathbb{E}[X^2] - \mathbb{E}[X]^2 \geq 0$$

(i.e. variance are non-negative)

- The KL-divergence $\text{KL}(f\|g)$ between two categorical probability distributions $(f_1, f_2, \dots)$ and $(g_1, g_2, \dots)$ is define as

$$\text{KL}(f\|g) = - \sum_i f_i \log \left(\frac{g_i}{f_i} \right)$$

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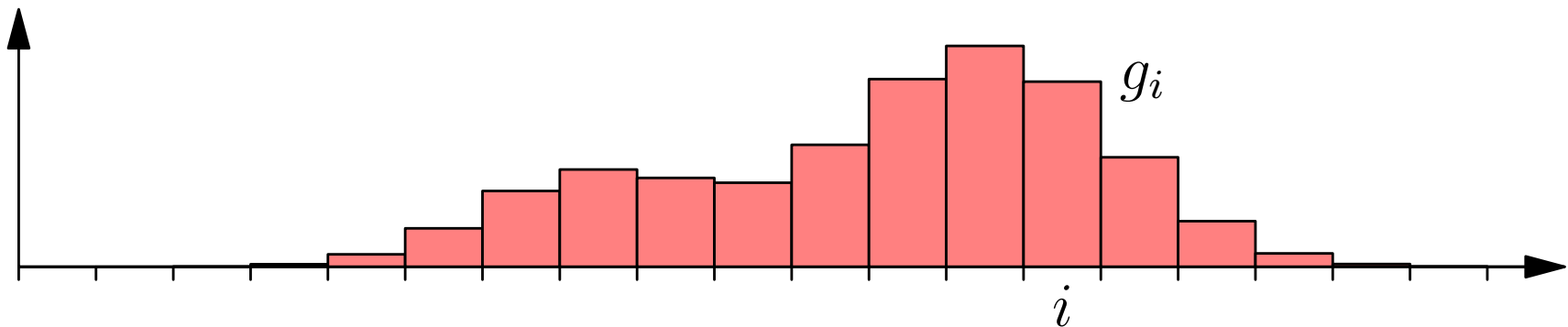
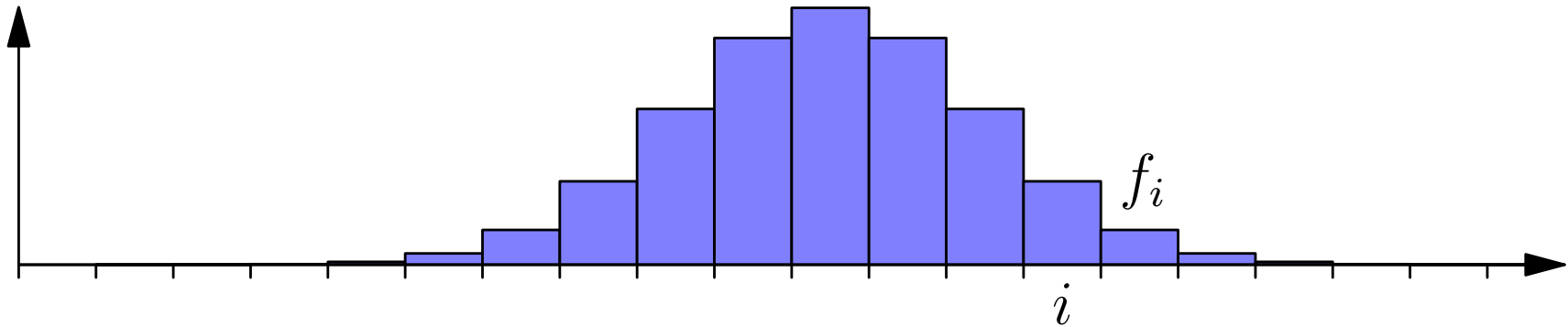
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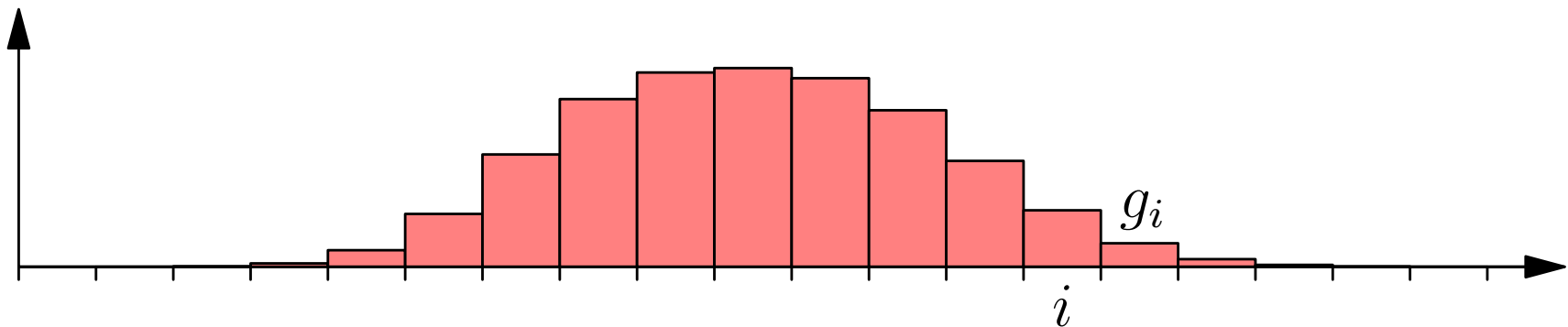
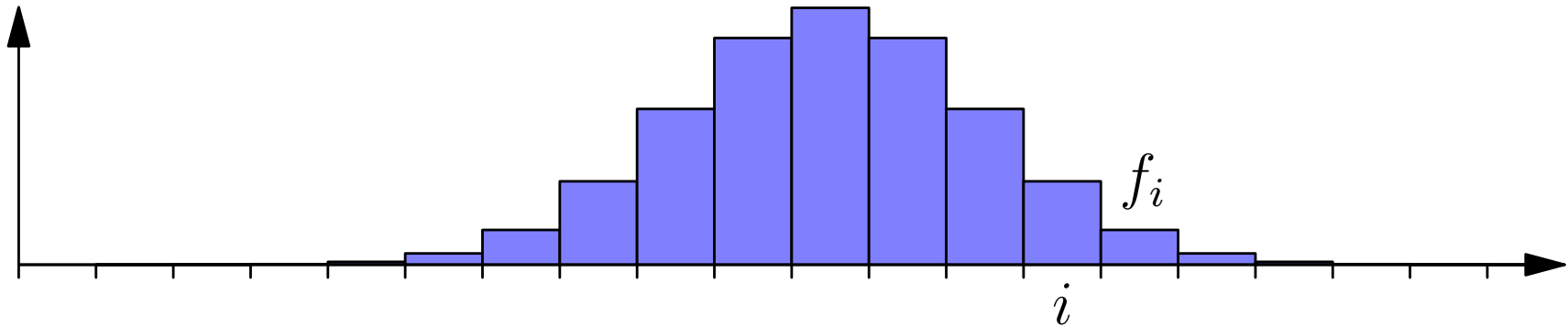
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Kullback-Leibler Divergence



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- To show that $\text{KL}(f\|g) \geq 0$ (Gibbs' inequality) we note that since the logarithm is a convex-down function

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- We will meet KL-divergences later on

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